



Figure 3: Accessing the slides

Code organisation and implementation details

Slidifier is the ideal example to showcase the power of JavaScript. Ninety-two per cent of its functionality is realised using JavaScript and the remaining through a combination of HTML, PHP and MySQL. The database is only used when the author chooses to archive the presentation for future retrieval or viewing. The functionality of text parsing, conversion to HTML, display in slide format, time and slide counts, etc, are all implemented in JavaScript. CSS is used to implement new templates or themes to achieve different looks for the slides.

slidifier.html is the parent file in which all js files are included and the form to input text is displayed. This file also contains the sample slide content for you to try.

Directory structure

Given below are the key directories that require to be explored to extend the functionality of Slidifier.

- `css` – stores the themes *black*, *white* and *colourful*
- `js` – the directory that contains most of the functionality. Includes files to parse the slides (*slideparser.js*), prepare slide layouts (*slidifier.js*), load themes, capture key strokes (*ui.js*), etc.

Creating more templates using CSS

It's easy to create new themes either based on existing ones or by creating entirely new CSS files. With CSS3, great themes can be generated using features like gradient, etc.

Creating 'Pecha Kucha' style presentations

An effective presentation style that evolved in Japan and gained popularity across the world is the 'Pecha Kucha' style. This methodology ensures that the slides have a lot of graphic content and little text. The key aspect that differentiates this style is the timing of each slide. The presenters have 20 slides in all and each slide is shown for 20 seconds. That keeps the presentation well-paced and to the point.



Figure 4: One of the templates of Slidifier

We can extend Slidifier's functionality to include a timer that changes each slide after exactly 20 seconds. This can be achieved by introducing the code given below in the *slidifier.js* file. This line should be inserted just after the 'refresh()' function is called.

```
setInterval("slideForward()", 1000*20);  
// Forward slide after 20 seconds
```

Now, isn't that simple?

Other Web-based presentation software

There are many other Web-based (HTML) presentation software that are more sophisticated and have a rich UI. But they need the author to have a good knowledge of HTML, CSS and programming. Some software also have a sharp learning curve before one can understand the functions provided. And the ease of carrying the presentation is sacrificed as the author needs to carry a set of HTML, JS and CSS files. 

References

- [1] Slidifier Home - <http://slidifier.com/>
- [2] Web based slideshow software - http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Web-based_slideshow
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